

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 19, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 27:1-25

1 The word of the Lord came again to me, saying,

2 "Now, son of man, take up a lamentation for Tyre,

3 and say to Tyre, 'You who are situated at the entrance of the sea, merchant of the peoples on many coastlands, thus says the Lord God: "O Tyre, you have said, 'I am perfect in beauty.'

4 Your borders are in the midst of the seas. Your builders have perfected your beauty.

5 They made all your planks of fir trees from Senir; They took a cedar from Lebanon to make you a mast.

6 Of oaks from Bashan they made your oars; The company of Ashurites have inlaid your planks With ivory from the coasts of Cyprus.

7 Fine embroidered linen from Egypt was what you spread for your sail; Blue and purple from the coasts of Elishah was what covered you.

8 "Inhabitants of Sidon and Arvad were your oarsmen; Your wise men, O Tyre, were in you; They became your pilots.

9 Elders of Gebal and its wise men Were in you to caulk your seams; All the ships of the sea And their oarsmen were in you To market your merchandise.

10 "Those from Persia, Lydia, and Libya Were in your army as men of war; They hung shield and helmet in you; They gave splendor to you.

11 Men of Arvad with your army were on your walls all around, And the men of Gammad were in your towers; They hung their shields on your walls all around; They made your beauty perfect.

12 "Tarshish was your merchant because of your many luxury goods. They gave you silver, iron, tin, and lead for your goods.

13 Javan, Tubal, and Meshech were your traders. They bartered human lives and vessels of bronze for your merchandise.

14 Those from the house of Togarmah traded for your wares with horses, steeds, and mules.

15 The men of Dedan were your traders; many isles were the market of your hand. They brought you ivory tusks and ebony as payment.

16 Syria was your merchant because of the abundance of goods you made. They gave you for your wares emeralds, purple, embroidery, fine linen, corals, and rubies.

17 Judah and the land of Israel were your traders. They traded for your merchandise wheat of Minnith, millet, honey, oil, and balm.

18 Damascus was your merchant because of the abundance of goods you made, because of your many luxury items, with the wine of Helbon and with white wool.

19 Dan and Javan paid for your wares, traversing back and forth. Wrought iron, cassia, and cane were among your merchandise.

20 Dedan was your merchant in saddlecloths for riding.

21 Arabia and all the princes of Kedar were your regular merchants. They traded with you in lambs, rams, and goats.

22 The merchants of Sheba and Raamah were your merchants. They traded for your wares the choicest spices, all kinds of precious stones, and gold.

23 Haran, Canneh, Eden, the merchants of Sheba, Assyria, and Chilmad were your merchants.

24 These were your merchants in choice items—in purple clothes, in embroidered garments, in chests of multicolored apparel, in sturdy woven cords, which were in your marketplace.

25 "The ships of Tarshish were carriers of your merchandise. You were filled and very glorious in the midst of the seas.

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to take up a lamentation for Tyre, a city that had said of itself, "I am

perfect in beauty."

- The passage pictures Tyre as a magnificent ship: planks of fir from Senir, a mast of cedar from Lebanon, oars of oak from Bashan, a sail of embroidered linen from Egypt; oarsmen from Sidon and Arvad, seam-caulkers from Gebal, and soldiers from Persia, Lydia, and Libya.
 - Verses 12-25 list the nations trading with Tyre and the goods they exchanged—silver, iron, tin, lead, horses, ivory, precious stones, wheat, honey, oil, spices, and gold—and verse 13 records that Javan, Tubal, and Meshech bartered human lives for her merchandise.
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III. Passage Analysis

"I Am Perfect in Beauty"

Tyre became proud because of her economic prosperity and the beauty of her natural setting. In the same way, when a person does not treasure the gospel of truth as beautiful but boasts instead in "the lust of the flesh and the lust of the eyes," that person falls into an empty self-admiration that drifts away from God. [1]

Tyre's pride didn't come from nowhere—she really was beautiful and really was wealthy. The trouble started when she made those things her name tag, admired herself long enough to believe it, and left no room for God.

This Is Actually a Lamentation

In elegies it is usual to insert encomiums of those whose fall we lament; the prophet, accordingly, praises Tyre for all that she had that was praiseworthy. [2]

So the cedar, the embroidered sail, the gems and gold are all part of a eulogy. While Tyre still sat at her peak with the cargo still on board, God had already told the prophet to sing her funeral song.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you feel like you own a lot? Does having it make you proud?

Tyre had the goods of the whole world and said, "I am perfect in beauty," yet God declared judgment on her and told the prophet to sing her a lamentation.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site, Precept Bible Study Commentary,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT27.htm>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on the Whole Bible,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Eze/Eze_027.cfm